

Bachata Level 1 (Beginner) – 8 Session Course Plan

Naresh Chaurasia

Version 1.0, 2026-07-10: First Edition

Table of Contents

Bachata Techniques	2
Classroom Sessions	3
For Revision	7
Level 1 Outcome	9

```
<style>
.tips-grid { display: flex; flex-wrap: wrap; gap: 1rem; margin: 1.5rem 0; }
.tip-card { flex: 1 1 200px; background: linear-gradient(135deg, #fef9f0, #fff4e6);
border-left: 4px solid #e67e22; border-radius: 8px; padding: 1rem 1.2rem; display: flex;
flex-direction: column; align-items: center; text-align: center; }
.tip-icon { font-size: 1.6rem; margin-bottom: 0.4rem; }
.tip-text { font-size: 0.9rem; line-height: 1.4; color: #444; }
</style>
```

This curriculum is designed to help complete beginners develop a strong foundation in Bachata by balancing:

- Solo footwork
- Body movement
- Partner connection
- Social dancing

The focus is **quality over quantity**. Rather than teaching many patterns, students should become comfortable with timing, leading, following, musicality, and confidence on the dance floor.

Bachata Techniques

Key Bachata techniques and tips for improving your dance, including footwork, hip movement, turns, and partner connection.

```
<div class="tips-grid">
  <div class="tip-card">
    <div class="tip-text">Keep your knees slightly bent/soft and relaxed</div>
  </div>
  <div class="tip-card">
    <div class="tip-text">Move hips naturally opposite your step direction</div>
  </div>
  <div class="tip-card">
    <div class="tip-text">Maintain a strong and stable frame</div>
  </div>
  <div class="tip-card">
    <div class="tip-text">Keep your hand at her forehead level when turning</div>
  </div>
  <div class="tip-card">
    <div class="tip-text">Proper posture & connection / block / resistance</div>
  </div>
</div>

<style>
.session-grid { display: flex; flex-direction: column; gap: 1.25rem; margin: 1.5rem 0; }
.session-card { background: #fafafa; border: 1px solid #e0e0e0; border-radius: 10px;
padding: 1rem 1.5rem; }
.session-card h3 { margin: 0 0 0.5rem 0; font-size: 1.2rem; color: #d35400; }
.session-tag { display: inline-block; background: #fef3e2; color: #e67e22; font-size:
0.8rem; font-weight: 600; padding: 0.15rem 0.6rem; border-radius: 4px; margin-bottom:
0.75rem; }
.session-moves { display: flex; flex-wrap: wrap; gap: 0.5rem; }
.session-move { background: #fff; border: 1px solid #ddd; border-radius: 6px; padding:
0.3rem 0.75rem; font-size: 0.9rem; color: #333; white-space: nowrap; }
</style>
```

Classroom Sessions

Bachata Level 1 (Beginner) – 8 Session Course Plan covering foundational techniques, partner work, body movement, and social dancing.

```
<div class="session-grid">
```

```
<div class="session-card">
```

```
<h3>Session 1 □ Bachata Foundation</h3>
```

```
<div class="session-tag">Solo & Partner Basics</div>
```

```
<div class="session-moves">
```

```
<span class="session-move">Bachata Timing & Counts</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Side Basic</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Tap Technique</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Weight Transfer</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Hip Movement Basics</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Forward Basic</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Backward Basic</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Musicality □ Finding the Beat</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Walking Basic</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">In-Place Basic</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Square (Box) Basic</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Quarter-Turn Basic</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Step-Tap Drills</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Open Hold</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Closed Hold (Frame)</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Leader & Follower Connection</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Dancing the Basic Together</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Open □ Closed Hold Transitions</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Gentle Push-Pull Connection</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Walking Together</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Side Travel</span>
```

```
</div>
```

```
</div>
```

```
<div class="session-card">
```

```
<h3>Session 2 □ Turns & Direction Changes</h3>
```

```
<div class="session-tag">Turns & Holds</div>
```

```
<div class="session-moves">
```

```
<span class="session-move">Basic Turn Technique</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Spotting</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Balance</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Arm Styling Basics</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Turn Preparation</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Hand Placement</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Turn Timing (Counts 3□4 or 7□8)</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Free Spin Preparation</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Double-Hand Hold</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Left-to-Left Hand Hold</span>
```

```

    <span class="session-move">Half Turn</span>
    <span class="session-move">Turn and Return</span>
    <span class="session-move">Follower Right Turn</span>
    <span class="session-move">Follower Left Turn</span>
    <span class="session-move">Leader Turn</span>
    <span class="session-move">Hand Change</span>
    <span class="session-move">Cross-hand Position</span>
  </div>
</div>

<div class="session-card">
  <h3>Session 3 □ Direction Changes & Social Dance Patterns</h3>
  <div class="session-tag">Direction Changes & Patterns</div>
  <div class="session-moves">
    <span class="session-move">Cross-Body Travel</span>
    <span class="session-move">Open Break</span>
    <span class="session-move">Walk Around Each Other</span>
    <span class="session-move">Follow the Leader</span>
    <span class="session-move">Change Places</span>
    <span class="session-move">Walk-Through Turn</span>
    <span class="session-move">Half-Circle Walk</span>
    <span class="session-move">Box Step</span>
    <span class="session-move">Diagonal Basic</span>
    <span class="session-move">Intro to Syncopation</span>
    <span class="session-move">Inside Turn</span>
    <span class="session-move">Outside Turn</span>
  </div>
</div>

<div class="session-card">
  <h3>Session 4 □ Bachata Moderna Basics</h3>
  <div class="session-tag">Body Isolation & Positions</div>
  <div class="session-moves">
    <span class="session-move">Chest Isolation</span>
    <span class="session-move">Rib Isolation</span>
    <span class="session-move">Hip Isolation</span>
    <span class="session-move">Shoulder Movement</span>
    <span class="session-move">Body Coordination</span>
    <span class="session-move">Shadow Position</span>
    <span class="session-move">Hammerlock</span>
    <span class="session-move">Cuddle Position</span>
    <span class="session-move">Wrap & Unwrap</span>
    <span class="session-move">Sweetheart Position</span>
    <span class="session-move">Cape Position</span>
    <span class="session-move">Reverse Hammerlock</span>
    <span class="session-move">Basket Hold (Simple)</span>
    <span class="session-move">Easy Pretzel Entry</span>
  </div>
</div>

<div class="session-card">

```

```

<h3>Session 5 ▯ Sensual Bachata Introduction</h3>
<div class="session-tag">Beginner Safe</div>
<div class="session-moves">
  <span class="session-move">Compression vs Extension</span>
  <span class="session-move">Weight Transfer for Body Waves</span>
  <span class="session-move">Side Body Movement</span>
  <span class="session-move">Circular Basic Motion</span>
  <span class="session-move">Body Wave Mechanics</span>
  <span class="session-move">Chest Isolation</span>
  <span class="session-move">Hip Circles</span>
  <span class="session-move">Head Movement Technique</span>
  <span class="session-move">Side Body Wave</span>
  <span class="session-move">Forward Body Wave</span>
  <span class="session-move">Hip Pulse</span>
  <span class="session-move">Chest Pulse</span>
  <span class="session-move">Frame & Connection</span>
  <span class="session-move">Simple Body Wave Lead</span>
  <span class="session-move">Preparation Signals</span>
</div>
</div>

<div class="session-card">
  <h3>Session 6 ▯ Footwork & Styling</h3>
  <div class="session-tag">Shines & Styling</div>
  <div class="session-moves">
    <span class="session-move">Basic Shines</span>
    <span class="session-move">Direction Changes</span>
    <span class="session-move">Tap Variations</span>
    <span class="session-move">Foot Taps</span>
    <span class="session-move">Slide Step</span>
    <span class="session-move">Hip Styling</span>
    <span class="session-move">Arm Styling</span>
    <span class="session-move">Heel Tap</span>
    <span class="session-move">Toe Tap</span>
    <span class="session-move">Cross Step</span>
    <span class="session-move">V-Step</span>
    <span class="session-move">Grapevine</span>
    <span class="session-move">Triple Tap</span>
    <span class="session-move">Syncopated Side Basic</span>
    <span class="session-move">Easy Suzy Q</span>
    <span class="session-move">Slide & Tap</span>
    <span class="session-move">Break Away for Shines</span>
    <span class="session-move">Mirror Shines</span>
  </div>
</div>

<div class="session-card">
  <h3>Session 7 ▯ Full Social Dancing</h3>
  <div class="session-tag">Social Dance Flow</div>
  <div class="session-moves">
    <span class="session-move">How to Start a Dance</span>

```

```

    <span class="session-move">How to Invite a Partner</span>
    <span class="session-move">Floor Etiquette</span>
    <span class="session-move">Leading Softly</span>
    <span class="session-move">Following Without Guessing</span>
    <span class="session-move">Basic → Travel → Turn</span>
    <span class="session-move">Inside Turn → Shadow → Exit</span>
    <span class="session-move">Leader Turn → Basic</span>
    <span class="session-move">Body Wave → Basic → End</span>
    <span class="session-move">Turn → Hammerlock → Shadow</span>
    <span class="session-move">Body Wave → Turn Exit</span>
  </div>
</div>

<div class="session-card">
  <h3>Session 8 □ Revision, Choreography & Social Practice</h3>
  <div class="session-tag">Revision & Practice</div>
  <div class="session-moves">
    <span class="session-move">All Basics</span>
    <span class="session-move">Partner Switching</span>
    <span class="session-move">Musicality</span>
    <span class="session-move">Mini Choreography</span>
    <span class="session-move">Basics Only (Round 1)</span>
    <span class="session-move">Basics + Turns (Round 2)</span>
    <span class="session-move">Turns + Shadow + Hammerlock (Round 3)</span>
    <span class="session-move">Footwork + Partner Work (Round 4)</span>
    <span class="session-move">Freestyle with Partner Rotation (Round 5)</span>
  </div>
</div>

</div>

```

For Revision

Revision checklist covering beginner footwork, partner connection, turns, direction changes, positions, body movement, and styling.

```
<div class="session-grid">
```

```
<div class="session-card">
```

```
<h3>Basic Footwork</h3>
```

```
<div class="session-tag">Footwork Revision</div>
```

```
<div class="session-moves">
```

```
<span class="session-move">Side Basic</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Forward & Back Basic</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Walking Basic</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Box Step</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Diagonal Basic</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Tap Variations</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Basic Syncopation</span>
```

```
</div>
```

```
</div>
```

```
<div class="session-card">
```

```
<h3>Partner Connection</h3>
```

```
<div class="session-tag">Holds & Connection</div>
```

```
<div class="session-moves">
```

```
<span class="session-move">Open Hold</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Closed Hold</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Hand Change</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Cross-hand Hold</span>
```

```
</div>
```

```
</div>
```

```
<div class="session-card">
```

```
<h3>Turns</h3>
```

```
<div class="session-tag">Turn Techniques</div>
```

```
<div class="session-moves">
```

```
<span class="session-move">Follower Right Turn</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Follower Left Turn</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Leader Turn</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Inside Turn</span>
```

```
<span class="session-move">Outside Turn</span>
```

```
</div>
```

```
</div>
```

```
<div class="session-card">
```

```
<h3>Direction Changes</h3>
```

```
<div class="session-tag">Movement Patterns</div>
```

```
<div class="session-moves">
```

```
<span class="session-move">Open Break</span>
```

```

    <span class="session-move">Change Places</span>
    <span class="session-move">Walk-through</span>
    <span class="session-move">Cross-body Travel</span>
  </div>
</div>

<div class="session-card">
  <h3>Positions & Patterns</h3>
  <div class="session-tag">Partner Positions</div>
  <div class="session-moves">
    <span class="session-move">Shadow</span>
    <span class="session-move">Sweetheart</span>
    <span class="session-move">Hammerlock</span>
    <span class="session-move">Cuddle</span>
    <span class="session-move">Wrap & Unwrap</span>
  </div>
</div>

<div class="session-card">
  <h3>Body Movement</h3>
  <div class="session-tag">Body Movement</div>
  <div class="session-moves">
    <span class="session-move">Basic Body Wave</span>
    <span class="session-move">Side Body Wave</span>
  </div>
</div>

<div class="session-card">
  <h3>Styling</h3>
  <div class="session-tag">Shines & Styling</div>
  <div class="session-moves">
    <span class="session-move">Basic Shines</span>
    <span class="session-move">Simple Styling</span>
  </div>
</div>

<div class="session-card">
  <h3>Dance Skills</h3>
  <div class="session-tag">Social Dance</div>
  <div class="session-moves">
    <span class="session-move">Musicality Basics</span>
    <span class="session-move">Social Dance Etiquette</span>
  </div>
</div>

</div>

```

Level 1 Outcome

By the end of this course, students should be able to:

- Dance confidently to Bachata music.
- Lead or follow comfortably using proper connection.
- Perform beginner turns and social dance combinations.
- Understand musical timing and rhythm.
- Transition smoothly between common dance positions.
- Dance socially with different partners while maintaining good etiquette.



Focus on **quality over quantity** — rather than teaching many patterns, students should become comfortable with timing, leading, following, musicality, and confidence on the dance floor.